

Sometimes, you'll get this: *"I can't do anything, sir. It's not possible to change anything"*

Your best response is: *"Sure you can. I'll give you 3 reasons and then I'll let you decide:*

- 1) *I just lost my job and the economy doesn't look bright. I can't afford this payment*
- 2) *I've been a loyal customer of yours for X years and recommended your service to more than 10 people (this is very helpful, sways even the stubborn reps)*
- 3) *I know customer acquisition 'costs' run into 5 figures. But retention is very simple here. It has zero costs and all you have to do is say YES.*

Rep: *"Ok...Hold on, let me ask my supervisor....It looks like we can do this for you this time alone sir."* WOHO!

90% of the reps give in when you mention that you can't afford it along with info of customer acquisition costs. But you'll still end up with the stubborn NO. Your best option is to put down the phone, call again and be handled by a lesser close-fisted rep (My usual success call rate before I get the job done is: 5 calls over 3 days; be patient with this system).

With satellite TV negotiations: The main customer service department aren't empowered to lower prices or provide offers. Hence, ask to be transferred to the retention department immediately. Ask the retention department to lower your bill by 300-400 per month and let them know you'll pay for the entire year right now. Drop the same info of unemployment – '*not affordable*' and mention customer acquisition costs. They will say they have your request on file and will provide offers on a rolling basis with the loyal customers. Don't give in yet. Call once a day, every-day for a week and they'll offer you a subsidized bill along with the chance to cull a few channels from your package. Be willing to trade and sacrifice a few TV channels to get this done. I've traded down channels worth 150 to reduce monthly bills by 400 ^[14] .

Internet and Phone Bills: Let them explain why they can't reduce the prices. Then counter those reasons with your '*5-figure customer acquisition*' stat. You could score majorly, if you can secure the same